

Boat Purchase Analysis — 2026 Nautique G23

Independent market verification · August 16, 2026 · Every price re-checked against current listings; all math machine-verified

RECOMMENDATION: PROCEED AT \$329,100 — a fair market price, and buying now beats waiting.

Condition: this makes sense if the current boat's lack of power genuinely limits use. The upgrade costs roughly \$40,000–\$47,000 per year of ownership — the deal is fair, but it is not a bargain that pays for itself.

1. THE DEAL

Sticker (MSRP) — loaded build: 630 hp supercharged engine, telescoping tower, full options	\$409,000
Negotiated price (includes triple-axle trailer)	\$329,100
Discount off sticker (\$79,900 off)	19.5%

- **The \$409,000 sticker is legitimate.** An Idaho dealer (Tobler Marina, Hayden) lists a 2026 G23 with the same telescoping tower but the smaller 450 hp engine at \$378,781. The 630 hp upgrade was a \$25,910 factory option in 2021 and runs roughly \$30,000 today — that lands right at \$409,000.
- **19.5% off is the going rate, not a special favor.** Dealers publicly advertise 16.7–17.3% off before anyone negotiates, and owner-forum buyers have documented deals at 24.6–25% off in some regions.
- **Ignore the "25% effective discount" pitch.** It compares today's price to a guessed next-year sticker; nothing published supports the claimed 7% increase. The real discount is 19.5%.

2. ROOM TO ASK FOR A LITTLE MORE — AND WHY

The dealer is in the middle of the observed discount range, not at the edge. A polite ask for another **\$8,000–\$12,000 off (target \$317,000–\$321,000, about 21.5–22.5% off)** is backed by real leverage — and every \$10,000 off also saves \$600 of sales tax, so the true swing is **\$10,600 per \$10,000**:

- **Precedent:** buyers have documented 24.6–25% off on Nautique orders; ~17% is the advertised starting point at some dealers. 19.5% is a mid-range outcome, not a ceiling.
- **Market pressure:** 63% of dealers say new-boat inventory is too high (July 2025 dealer survey), wake boat retail sales are down about 10% this year, and dealers pay floor-plan interest every month a boat sits.
- **Timing:** late season, with 2027 models already listing — a 2026 sold now beats one carried into spring. The average boat listing now takes about seven months to sell, a month longer than a year ago.
- **Cross-shop leverage:** loaded G23 Paragons (higher trim, same 630 hp engine) advertise at \$365,375–\$389,000 — an honest comparison worth naming.
- **If they hold on price, take it in kind:** freight/prep in writing, first service, cover/accessories. Worst case is a "no."

3. QUESTIONS TO ASK THE DEALER — WITH THE NUMBERS BEHIND THEM

Question	Why it matters
"Is freight and prep included in the \$329,100, in writing?"	Currently unconfirmed — a \$3,000–\$8,000 surprise if it isn't.
"What exactly will you give me on trade, in writing?"	Decision rule: trade only beats selling private if a private sale would net under \$118,720 (the trade offer plus the 6% tax credit it carries).
"Can you get closer to \$317,000–\$320,000?"	That's 21.5–22.5% off — still below documented 24.6–25% deals, in a market where 63% of dealers report excess inventory.
"How many 2026 G23s do you have left, and when do 2027s arrive?"	The more 2026 stock they carry into the 2027 arrivals, the more room they have to move.
"Can you confirm the warranty terms in writing for this build — boat and engine?"	Nautique's boat warranty is 5 years / 1,000 hours plus a lifetime structural warranty (hull, deck, stringers). The PCM engine — including the supercharged ZZ8S — carries its own transferable 5-year / 1,000-hour warranty. Worth having both on paper; the supercharged engine is the costliest thing to fix once coverage ends.
"You said prices rise 7% next year — will you show me the factory notice?"	Nothing published supports 7%. If it's real they can show it; if not, it's a sales line.

4. WHAT THE 2020 BOAT IS WORTH

Year	Asking price	Detail	Source
2020	\$149,900	450 hp, 123 hrs — Mooresville, NC	OnlyInboards
2020	\$149,995	450 hp, 61 hrs — Irvine, CA (sale pending)	YachtWorld
2020	\$149,995	Dealer retail — Montgomery, TX	Boatzon
2020	\$124,967	Jacksons Gap, AL (low end)	Boat Trader
2020	\$155,000	Bakersfield, CA (high end)	Boat Trader
2021	\$158,000 SOLD	263 hrs — actual sale, May 16, 2025	OnlyInboards
2019	\$119,500–\$134,900	Three listings, TX / UT	Boatzon / Pop Yachts

- Used boats typically sell 5–12% below asking, and dealers value trades 10–20% below private-party value.
- **Private sale: plan on about \$130,000** (range \$125,000–\$138,000; \$135,000+ takes low hours and patience). **Dealer trade-in: expect \$108,000–\$118,000** — get their number in writing.

5. NET COST TO SWITCH (IDAHO 6% SALES TAX)

	Trade in at \$112,000	Sell private at \$130,000
Purchase price	\$329,100	\$329,100
Amount that gets taxed	\$217,100 (price minus trade)	\$329,100 (full price)
Sales tax at 6%	+ \$13,026	+ \$19,746
Money back from the 2020	– \$112,000	– \$130,000
Net cost to switch	\$230,126	\$218,846

- **Plain English:** trading in saves \$6,720 of tax, but selling private brings in \$18,000 more cash — **selling private comes out \$11,280 ahead.**
- **Sensitivity:** each \$10,000 more (or less) on the 2020's sale moves the net cost dollar-for-dollar — sell at \$120,000 and the net cost is \$228,846 (about even with trading in); sell at \$138,000 and it drops to \$210,846.

6. BUY NOW VS. WAIT THREE YEARS

Buying now costs \$253,342 in 2029 terms: the \$218,846 net outlay above, plus \$34,496 that money would have earned invested at 5% for three years. **Waiting means:** keep the 2020 (worth roughly \$100,000 by 2029), then buy new at 2029 prices, paying 6% tax on the full price.

If you wait until 2029...	2029 sticker	Price paid	Net cost then	Buying now saves
Best case: prices rise 5%/yr, 20% discounts persist	\$473,000	\$379,000	\$301,500	\$48,200
Middle case: prices rise 6%/yr, 15% discount	\$487,000	\$414,000	\$338,900	\$85,600
Worst case: prices rise 7%/yr, discounts shrink to 10%	\$501,000	\$451,000	\$378,000	\$124,700

- **Buying now is cheaper in every scenario tested** — by \$48,000 to \$125,000 — and skips three more years with the underpowered boat.
- Fair caveat: waiting ends with a brand-new 2029 boat instead of a three-year-old 2026. It only approaches a tie if big discounts persist, price increases stay low, invested cash earns ~10%, and the 2020 holds value unusually well — all at once.

7. WHAT THE SWITCH REALLY COSTS OVER 4 YEARS

	Buy the 2026	Keep the 2020
Value today / purchase basis	\$329,100	~\$130,000
Estimated value in 2030	\$185,000–\$205,000	\$95,000–\$105,000
Value lost over 4 years (depreciation)	\$124,000–\$144,000	\$25,000–\$35,000
Sales tax paid (gone either way)	\$19,746	—
Investment return given up on the cash (5%/yr)	~\$47,200	—
Extra cost of switching, 4 years	~\$157,000–\$187,000 — about \$40,000–\$47,000 per year	

That is the honest price of running a new 630 hp boat under full warranty instead of the 2020. The discount doesn't change it — the justification is use and enjoyment, not economics.

8. RESALE NOTES

- Nautique moved the G-Series to a new generation starting with the 2025–2026 models. The 2020 is the old body style, and more than a hundred leftover new old-body G23s are still being cleared at discounts, which caps its value. **That argues for selling the 2020 sooner, not later.** The 2026 being purchased is the current body style, which helps its future resale.
- Worth one call before signing: loaded G23 Paragons with the same engine ask \$365,375–\$389,000 — for \$35,000–\$60,000 more it may be the stronger long-term hold.

Sources: current listings on Boat Trader, OnlyInboards, YachtWorld, Boatzon, Pop Yachts and dealer sites (Tobler Marina, Russell Marine, Buxton Marine, Ugly John's, American Boat Center); Idaho State Tax Commission (6% rate and dealer trade-in credit); nautique.com and pcmengines.com (warranty terms); PlanetNautique owner forums (documented discount reports); NMMA retail data, Trade Only Today dealer-sentiment survey, and Denison 2025 market report (market statistics). Listing prices are asking prices unless marked SOLD; every listed price was independently re-verified. Full source URLs are in the companion detailed report (boat-deal-verification.md).